THE SOUTHWEST MONSOONS ROLLED IN EARLY THIS YEAR, covering the whole of India by June 29, nine days before target date. Good rains are crucial for the kharif season, but this year, it looks like we might have it in torrents. Aggregated reports suggest that over 52 districts in 19 states are severely affected by flooding, and it's still only early July. The Indian Meteorological Department predicts 108 per cent of the Long Period Average (LPA) for June-September—and the problem is its erratic trajectory. Rains came early all over the Northeast, wreaking destruction, and it soon began finding unusual company in the Northwest, Central, East and North. Flash floods in Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, the Narmada and Tapi overflowing in Gujarat, reservoirs breaking banks in West Bengal and, now, a second wave in the Northeast, causing flash floods in Manipur, landslides in Mizoram, floods in Arunachal and Meghalaya, with the Brahmaputra and another 10 rivers in spate in Assam. A deluge leaving a whole flood of misery in its wake.

